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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part V

Regional cooperation for development

Section 22

Economic and social development in Western Asia

Programme 19

Economic and social development in Western Asia

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 22)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 22)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 22.1 The Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA) is responsible for promoting inclusive and sustainable development in the Arab region. The mandate derives from the priorities established in relevant General Assembly and Economic and Social Council resolutions and decisions, including Council resolution [1818 \(LV\)](#) establishing the Commission and resolution [1985/69](#) amending its terms of reference to emphasize its social functions. The Commission's membership includes 21 Arab member States.
- 22.2 The adoption of the Pact for the Future (see General Assembly resolution [79/1](#)) is a crucial opportunity to redefine the trajectory of the Arab region, which, notwithstanding its potential and human capital, is still not on track for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the achievement of all its Goals. The development gains achieved to date continue to be jeopardized by conflict, which, in some cases, has set back progress by decades; political instability and social unrest; governance challenges, social and economic challenges; and the impact of a changing climate on ecosystems. These developments are balanced by educated and highly motivated young people, abundant natural resources and innovative industrial investment. The Pact for the Future offers the region another chance to harness the transformative power of artificial intelligence, digital innovation and predictive analytics, in line with the Global Digital Compact, to address the complex and interrelated challenges that it faces, including economic volatility, social inequalities, conflicts and the threats of climate change; and to take decisive action towards achieving the aspirations of the people of the Arab region for a prosperous future for all. Given its regional mandate, ESCWA is uniquely positioned to support national development trajectories and priorities by leveraging its expertise, toolkits and partnerships, in support of jointly owned development solutions and outcomes.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 22.3 The Commission's programme of work for 2027 remains guided by universal principles and rights, aligned with its mandates, and centred on tailored and timely support to member States in their efforts to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals. To deliver on this commitment, ESCWA will continue to provide evidence-based, novel policy options, underpinned by analysis made possible by its suite of interactive, data-driven modelling and policy simulation tools and knowledge repositories; to provide technical advice and enhance human and institutional capacities, including through peer-to-peer exchanges and the promotion of South-South and interregional collaboration; to leverage its convening role to promote inclusive dialogue, at the national and regional levels and forge consensus on viable development solutions; and to advocate for whole-of-government and whole-of-society approaches to accelerate progress against the Goals and their targets, while championing the region's perspective through a global lens. The programme of work remains focused on high-impact interventions as a means of achieving inclusive and equitable development outcomes, which address the specific needs of groups in vulnerable situations, including women, young people, older persons and persons with disabilities; and the diverse and specific challenges of least developed and middle-income countries and countries in conflict, in line with the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the Decade 2022–2031.
- 22.4 As defined by the objectives of the six subprogrammes, the Commission's programme of work remains focused on areas such as climate action and the integrated management of water resources; the transition to new and renewable sources of energy, sustainable food systems and circular economy approaches; multidimensional poverty reduction and inclusive social protection; social and

gender justice, women's economic empowerment and improved access to labour markets, as part of the commitment to "leave no one behind"; macroeconomic, fiscal and trade policies, competitiveness of the business environment, and opportunities for small and medium-sized enterprises; improved access to innovative sources of development finance and sustainable debt management; information technology and statistics; the transparency and accessibility of public institutions, including through digitization; innovation and digital transformation; and governance, the assessment and mitigation of transboundary risks, including conflict, and boosting the effectiveness and efficiency of public administration.

- 22.5 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, ESCWA will sustain its strategic partnership with the League of Arab States and other intergovernmental organizations, as well as the Islamic Development Bank, the Arab Fund for Economic and Social Development and other relevant financial institutions. It will also promote South-South and triangular cooperation and further enhance its outreach to academic institutions, think tanks, civil society organizations and the private sector. New partnership opportunities will also be pursued to enable the Commission to continue to deliver support to member States, including the production of knowledge products and the convening of policymakers and other stakeholders.
- 22.6 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, as outlined in General Assembly resolution [72/279](#), the Commission will continue to discharge its function of co-Vice Chair of the Regional Collaborative Platform for the Arab States and its subsidiary issue-based coalitions. It will also work closely with the Development Coordination Office, resident coordinator offices, United Nations country teams, other regional commissions, the World Bank, the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development to ensure that any support that it provides to member States is relevant, timely and effective and fully aligned with the commitments outlined within the national United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, while avoiding the duplication of interventions and gaps.
- 22.7 With regard to external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
 - (a) Sufficient opportunities for protecting and leveraging development gains for further progress towards the implementation of the 2030 Agenda exist, notwithstanding the increasingly volatile global, regional and national dynamics and increased need for urgent coordinated humanitarian action and peacebuilding efforts;
 - (b) Member States remain engaged and committed to collaborating on a range of sustainable development initiatives, with a specific focus on transboundary priorities and responses to emerging challenges;
 - (c) Development partners remain committed to collaboration on and joint implementation of development initiatives, including their prioritization, identification of innovative solutions and opportunities for specific contributions;
 - (d) The Commission's operational preparedness and adaptive capacity enable it to maintain business continuity, even amid compromised safety and security emerging from conflict, political and social instability and/or natural disasters.
- 22.8 ESCWA integrates a gender perspective into its activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate. This includes the provision of support to its member States in developing inclusive, gender-sensitive policy frameworks to address a wide range of economic and social issues and in enhancing the capacities of national institutions and actors, in addition to developing publications and technical materials specific to advancing gender equality and women's economic empowerment in the region. The Commission's commitment to gender equality remains in line with the United Nations global accountability framework and Economic and Social Council resolution [2023/11](#).
- 22.9 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, ESCWA will continue to make policy options available to member States and advocate in favour of the adoption of national frameworks

that promote the greater inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, including enhanced access to labour markets and basic social services.

- 22.10 ESCWA will integrate issues related to older persons and young people across its programme of work with the aim of augmenting their role as active contributors to the implementation of the 2030 Agenda. In this context, the Commission will: (a) promote their meaningful participation and inclusion in development dialogues; (b) generate and disseminate knowledge essential for developing policies that are responsive to the needs of young people and older persons; (c) facilitate peer-to-peer learning among member States within the region and beyond; and (d) support member States in the adoption and implementation of policies that protect the rights of young people and older persons.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 22.11 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026. For example, starting in 2026, ESCWA has scaled back its work on poverty and social justice within subprogramme 2, logistics, transport and trade facilitation within subprogramme 3, and risk assessment and conflict prevention within subprogramme 6. In addition, given that ESCWA has discontinued its work on trade data within subprogramme 4 activities related to the production of external trade statistics under result 2 of subprogramme 4 have been discontinued. These reflect mainly the identification of activities for which specialized agencies and other United Nations entities have the comparative advantage in implementation.
- 22.12 ESCWA will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions concerning proposals for strengthening collaboration with the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development, the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the other regional commissions through joint mechanisms. ESCWA will jointly explore options for strengthening macroeconomic analysis capacities, with a view to contributing more harmonized analysis and policy support to Member States.

Legislative mandates

- 22.13 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme:

General Assembly resolutions

63/260	Development-related activities	76/258	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries
69/277	Political declaration on strengthening cooperation between the United Nations and regional and subregional organizations	78/1	Political declaration of the high-level political forum on sustainable development convened under the auspices of the General Assembly
69/313	Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development	79/1	The pact for the future
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	79/12	Cooperation between the United Nations and the League of Arab States
72/279	Repositioning of the United Nations development system in the context of the quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system	79/195 79/201 79/226	International trade and development Entrepreneurship for sustainable development Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system

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79/228	Towards global partnerships: a principle-based approach to enhanced cooperation between the United Nations and all relevant partners	80/127	Promoting investments for sustainable development
		80/148	Culture and sustainable development
79/323	Sevilla Commitment	80/154	Eradicating rural poverty to implement the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
80/5	Doha Political Declaration of the “World Social Summit” under the title “the Second World Summit for Social Development”	80/155	Operational activities for development of the United Nations system
80/125	Financial inclusion for sustainable development	80/156	South-South cooperation

Economic and Social Council resolutions

1818 (LV)	Establishment of an Economic Commission for Western Asia	2021/3	New strategic vision of the Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia
1985/69	Amendment of the terms of reference of the Economic Commission for Western Asia: change of name of the Commission	2024/19	Progress in the implementation of General Assembly resolution 75/233 on the quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system
2017/7	Work of the Statistical Commission pertaining to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development		

Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia ministerial declarations and resolutions

Tunis Declaration on Social Justice in the Arab Region (2014)	345 (XXXI)	War on Gaza and support for the Palestinian people
Doha Declaration on the Implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (2016)	346 (XXXI)	Effective economic governance and modernization of public administration
Beirut Consensus on Technology for Sustainable Development in the Arab Region (2018)	347 (XXXI)	Arab Vision 2045
Arab Declaration on Progress in Implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action after 25 Years (2019)	348 (EC.10)	Programme performance for the period 2024–2025 and proposed programme plan for 2027 in view of the UN80 Initiative
286 (XXV) Gender statistics for equality and empowerment of women	349 (EC.10)	Adoption of the session reports of subsidiary bodies of the Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia
331 (XXX) Comprehensive approaches to technical cooperation in response to member States’ emerging needs		

Subprogramme 1 Climate change and natural resource sustainability

General Assembly resolutions

71/222	International Decade for Action, “Water for Sustainable Development,” 2018–2028	80/131	The pivotal role of reliable and stable energy connectivity in driving sustainable development
77/282	Building global resilience and promoting sustainable development through regional and interregional infrastructure connectivity	80/135	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21
77/294	International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms		Disaster risk reduction
77/334	Follow-up to the United Nations Conference on the Midterm Comprehensive Review of the Implementation of the Objectives of the International Decade for Action, “Water for Sustainable Development”, 2018–2028	80/137 80/138 80/139	Protection of global climate for present and future generations of humankind Implementation of the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification in Those Countries Experiencing Serious Drought and/or Desertification, Particularly in Africa
78/314	United Nations Decade on Combating Sand and Dust Storms, (2025–2034)		

Part V		Regional cooperation for development	
80/142	Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all	80/157	Agriculture development, food security and nutrition
80/143	Combating sand and dust storms		
<i>Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia resolutions</i>			
281 (XXV)	Addressing climate change issues in the Arab region	329 (XXX)	Establishment of the Arab centre for climate change policies in the Arab region
Subprogramme 2 Gender justice, population and inclusive development			
<i>General Assembly resolutions</i>			
50/124	Implementation of the Programme of Action of the International Conference on Population and Development	79/221	Implementation of the Third United Nations Decade for the Eradication of Poverty (2018–2027)
57/167	Follow-up to the Second World Assembly on Ageing	79/223	Women in development
65/234	Follow-up to the International Conference on Population and Development beyond 2014	80/152	Contribution of the care economy to sustainable development
71/256	New Urban Agenda	80/178	Implementation of the outcome of the World Summit for Social Development and of the twenty-fourth special session of the General Assembly
73/195	Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	80/180	Policies and programmes involving youth
76/154	Implementation of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and the optional Protocol thereto: participation	80/181	Promoting social integration through social inclusion
76/273	Enhancing accessibility for persons with disabilities to conferences and meetings of the United Nations system	80/186	Follow-up to the Fourth World Conference on Women and full implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action and the outcome of the twenty-third special session of the General Assembly
79/149	Inclusive development for and with persons with disabilities	80/218	Protection of migrants
79/217	International migration and development		
<i>Security Council resolutions</i>			
1325 (2000)			
<i>Economic and Social Council resolutions</i>			
2011/5	The role of the United Nations system in implementing the internationally agreed goals and commitments in regard to gender equality and the empowerment of women	2024/6	Fostering social development and social justice through social policies to accelerate progress on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and to achieve the overarching goal of poverty eradication
2019/6	Addressing inequalities and challenges to social inclusion through fiscal, wage and social protection policies	2025/4	Mainstreaming a gender perspective into all policies and programmes in the United Nations system
2020/7	Affordable housing and social protection systems for all to address homelessness	2025/8	Modalities for the fifth review and appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002
<i>Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia declarations and resolutions</i>			
Muscat Declaration: Towards the Achievement of Gender justice in the Arab Region (2016)		304 (XXVII)	The role of participation and social justice in achieving sustainable development

**Subprogramme 3
Shared economic prosperity**

General Assembly resolutions

78/148	Strengthening the links between all modes of transport to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals	80/128	Promotion of inclusive and effective international tax cooperation at the United Nations
80/122	International financial system and development	80/129	Follow-up to and implementation of the outcomes of the International Conferences on Financing for Development
80/123	External debt sustainability and development	80/132	United Nations Decade of Sustainable Transport 2026–2035
80/126	Promotion of international cooperation to combat illicit financial flows and strengthen good practices on assets return to foster sustainable development	80/149	Development cooperation with middle-income countries

Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia resolutions

214 (XIX)	Establishment of a technical committee on liberalization of foreign trade and economic globalization in the countries of the ESCWA region	303 (XXVII)	Towards enhancing the macroeconomic policy in ESCWA member countries
		308 (XXVII)	The regional dimension of development
		338 (S-VII)	Establishment of an Arab integrated road safety observatory

**Subprogramme 4
Statistics, the information society and technology**

General Assembly resolutions

68/261	Adoption of the Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics	78/265	Seizing the opportunities of safe, secure and trustworthy artificial intelligence systems for sustainable development
71/313	Work of the Statistical Commission pertaining to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	78/311	Enhancing International Cooperation on Capacity-building of Artificial Intelligence
75/316	Impact of rapid technological change on the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and targets	79/194	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development
78/213	Promotion and protection of human rights in the context of digital technologies, which underscores the rights-based dimensions of digital and data policy	80/147	Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development
		80/173	Outcome document of the high-level meeting of the General Assembly on the overall review of the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2020/5	Strengthening coordination of the statistical programmes in the United Nations system	2025/18	Assessment of the progress made in the implementation of and follow-up to the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society
2022/24	Enhancing global geospatial information management arrangements		
2025/12	System of National Accounts 2025	2025/19	Science, technology and innovation for development
2025/13	2030 World Population and Housing Census Programme		

Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia resolutions

276 (XXIV); 287 (XXV)	Strengthening statistical capacities in the ESCWA region	283 (XXV)	ESCWA member country compliance with international standards for enhancing national statistical systems
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Part V		Regional cooperation for development	
294 (XXVI)	Establishment of the ESCWA technology centre	306 (XXVII)	Development of the Arab Internet Governance Forum process and sustaining efforts in the Arabic domain names field
Subprogramme 5 2030 Agenda and SDG coordination			
<i>General Assembly resolutions</i>			
67/290	Format and organizational aspects of the high-level political forum on sustainable development	78/285	Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolution 75/290 A on the strengthening of the Economic and Social Council and resolution 75/290 B on the high-level political forum on sustainable development and the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development at the global level
75/290 A; 75/290 B	Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolution 72/305 on the strengthening of the Economic and Social Council Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolutions 67/290 on the format and organizational aspects of the high-level political forum on sustainable development and 70/299 on the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development at the global level		
<i>Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia resolutions</i>			
314 (XXVIII)	The Arab Forum on Sustainable Development	327 (XXIX)	Working mechanisms of the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development
Subprogramme 6 Governance and conflict prevention			
<i>General Assembly resolutions</i>			
79/202	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on agenda 21	80/158	Permanent sovereignty of the Palestinian people in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and of the Arab population in the occupied Syrian Golan over their natural resources
80/119	Consumer product safety		
<i>Economic and Social Council resolutions</i>			
2025/31	Report of the Committee of Experts on Public Administration on its twenty-fourth session	2025/33	Economic and social repercussions of the Israeli occupation on the living conditions of the Palestinian people in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and the Arab population in the occupied Syrian Golan
<i>Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia resolutions</i>			
296 (XXVI)	Enhancing public sector institutions and resources to attain national development goals	330 (XXX)	Support for the Palestinian people

Deliverables

22.14 Table 22.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 22.1
Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	10	10	6	12
1. ESCWA ministerial session	–	–	4 [6]	6
2. Executive Committee	10	10	2 [4]	6
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	17	11	8	15
3. ESCWA ministerial session (special session)	–	–	2 [4]	6
4. Executive Committee	8	4	2 [4]	4
5. ESCWA Advisory Committee	2	2	– [1]	1
6. Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
7. Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
8. Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
9. Regional Collaborative Platform for Arab States	4	2	1 [3]	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	–	–
10. ESCWA annual report	–	–	–	–
11. System-wide annual results report	1	1	–	–
12. Report on megatrends (artificial intelligence)	1	1	–	–
C. Substantive deliverables				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Arab Development Portal and ESCWA e-learning portal.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: selected international days; the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development; other ESCWA forums, including the Arab Forum for Equality and the Arab Competition Forum; and awareness-raising activities on the work of the United Nations and ESCWA.				
External and media relations: briefings by the Executive Secretary and other senior officials; ESCWA livestreaming services; and press releases and media coverage on ESCWA activities.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: videos and other visual content on ESCWA activities; daily ESCWA news on the ESCWA website and social media accounts; and weekly digital newsletter.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Evaluation activities

- 22.15 The following evaluations, completed by ESCWA in 2025, have guided the programme plan for 2027:
- (a) Evaluation of the ESCWA Stories project;
 - (b) Evaluation of a project on reducing road deaths and injuries.
- 22.16 In response to the results of the evaluations referenced above, the Commission: (a) will continue to engage member States in positioning the ESCWA Stories model within broader education for sustainable development and will translate the lessons learned into programmatic delivery across areas of work; and (b) will further enhance road safety interventions by expanding outreach to civil society actors and ensuring strong multi-stakeholder coordination. The evaluation of ESCWA reform

and its new operational model planned for 2025 was not completed owing to liquidity-related constraints.

- 22.17 An evaluation of one of the six ESCWA subprogrammes is planned for 2027.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1

Climate change and natural resource sustainability

Objective

- 22.18 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance climate action and integrated and sustainable policies in the areas of water, energy and food security.

Strategy

- 22.19 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Deploy in-house expertise and collaborate with other United Nations entities and external experts to analyse and assess the impact of trends and challenges, and disseminate knowledge products pertaining to issues such as transboundary and the integrated management of water resources; land degradation; critical energy transition minerals; equitable, resilient, inclusive and sustainable food and energy systems; circular economy approaches; sand and dust storms; climate adaptation and mitigation and the means for assessing climate finance and data-driven knowledge platforms related to climate resilience;
 - (b) Provide technical and policy advice and expertise to member States and strengthen capacities at the regional, national and sectoral levels to use evidence and tools to identify and operationalize solutions and mainstream considerations related to climate change, sustainable natural resource management and food security into national development plans and budgets, and identify opportunities for financing climate action and adaptation;
 - (c) Convene intergovernmental platforms and technical bodies to facilitate cross-sectoral dialogue, consensus-building and peer-to-peer exchanges among policymakers, practitioners, experts, civil society and other development partners from within and outside the region to promote cooperation and coordination; foster consensus towards the development of national, transboundary and regional normative frameworks on the sustainable management of water, energy and land resources; and increase access to affordable, reliable and modern energy;
 - (d) Advocate with national Governments, regional intergovernmental bodies and relevant stakeholders, including through supporting integrated, regional reporting on and monitoring of progress against specific Sustainable Development Goal targets; promote joint solutions and the harmonization of positions; and leverage partnerships in support of the implementation and financing of such commitments.
- 22.20 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Adoption by member States of national policy frameworks and regional agreements related to climate action and the sustainable use and management of natural resources; reduced emissions; the transition away from fossil fuels in energy systems in a just, orderly and equitable manner; resilient food systems supported by sustainable agriculture; and improved climate resilience;
 - (b) Strengthened cooperation on issues outlined in paragraph 22.19 (a), supported by inclusive networks and participatory coordination mechanisms.

Programme performance in 2025

Arab least developed countries make the transition to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy supported by the deployment of risk-mitigating financial and business model tools

- 22.21 As identified in the Doha Programme of Action, the least developed countries in the Arab region continue to face barriers to energy access, including a persistent lack of access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy, low electrification rates, a reliance on traditional biomass systems and limited access to finance. To address these barriers, the subprogramme, together with regional and international partners, developed financial instruments, business models and digital toolkits to mitigate risks and promote scalable energy solutions. Member States benefited from knowledge products on financing approaches and project models for small-scale initiatives, while policy options and investment frameworks were prepared to guide the effective use of financial instruments and to mobilize capital for sustainable energy projects. Those efforts were further strengthened through regional workshops and capacity-building activities. This enabled officials and local actors, including rural women entrepreneurs, to apply microfinance, cost-accounting and project-development tools.
- 22.22 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.2).

Table 22.2

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Seventeen policymakers from six Arab least developed countries applied financial tools and business model toolkits that support energy access and mitigate sustainable energy investment risks Forty rural women from Mauritania apply cost-accounting and project development skills to ensure the transition to affordable, reliable and sustainable energy

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: transitioning to sustainable food systems

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.23 The subprogramme's work contributed to Lebanon's development of a national framework for making the transition to sustainable food systems, which met the planned target.
- 22.24 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.3).

Table 22.3
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States have access to regional tool for assessing food security	Two member States (Jordan and Lebanon) assessed their national food systems	One member State (Lebanon) developed a national framework for making the transition to sustainable food systems	One additional member State develops a framework for making the transition to sustainable food systems	One member State endorses a measure for financing resilient food systems pathways

Result 2: member States identify joint priority action to combat sand and dust storms

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.25 The subprogramme's work contributed to eight member States having access to an interregional dialogue series on sand and dust storms, which met the planned target.
- 22.26 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.4).

Table 22.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Member States have access to geospatial tools for enhanced analysis of sand and dust storms	Eight member States have access to interregional dialogue series on sand and dust storms	Member States identify joint priority action for sand and dust storm management in Western Asia and neighbouring areas	Two member States operationalize at least one priority action

Result 3: improved resilience of surface water and groundwater basins in the Arab region

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 22.27 Across the Arab region, climate change is contributing to a reduction in freshwater resources, prompting member States to strengthen basin resilience through targeted interventions supported by regional cooperation and policy frameworks. The subprogramme has built on the development of country-specific, climate-resilient watershed management packages in Algeria and Lebanon, laying the groundwork for basin initiatives integrating climate action.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.28 The lesson for the subprogramme is that its support for building resilience in surface water and groundwater basins was most effective when grounded in science-based assessments and combined with technical assistance to inform enabling policies to create conditions for local interventions. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will expand pilots to additional member States by systematically anchoring future interventions in science-based assessments that are adapted to local contexts and using evidence from implementation to guide policy tools for mainstreaming climate action into water governance.

22.29 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (table 22.5).

Table 22.5

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Arab Ministerial Water Council adopted a resolution to mandate regional preparation for the 2026 United Nations Water Conference to Accelerate the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 6: Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all	Tunisia launched a climate-resilient watershed management package for one basin	One additional basin finalizes a climate-resilient watershed management package Arab States delivered coordinated regional input for the 2026 United Nations Water Conference	Member States implement at least one regional initiative for resilient and sustainable freshwater management Arab States agree on joint priorities to accelerate resilient and sustainable freshwater management

Deliverables

22.30 Table 22.6 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.6

Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	12	12	–	12
1. Committee on Energy	6	6	–	6
2. Committee on Water Resources	6	6	–	6
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	42	34	22	32
3. Committee on Water Resources	4	4	–	4
4. Committee on Energy and its Expert Group on Extractive Industries	5	5	–	4
5. Committee on Water Resources and Committee on Energy (joint)	1	1	–	–
6. Executive Bureau of the Arab Ministerial Council for Electricity and its committees of experts on electricity and on renewable energy and energy efficiency	6	2	2 [6]	2
7. Arab Ministerial Water Council and its Technical, Scientific and Advisory Committee	6	–	6	6
8. Joint Ministerial Council for Water and Agriculture and its High-Level Joint Technical Committee	2	4	–	2
9. Arab Council of Ministers Responsible for Meteorology and Climate and its Permanent Committee for Meteorology, and Arab Climate Outlook Forum	10	10	6 [8]	6

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
10. Council of Arab Ministers Responsible for the Environment and its Technical Committee	8	8	8	8
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	9	8	7	5
11. Climate resilience through regional cooperation for inclusive sustainable development	1	1	1	1
12. Arab Centre for Climate Change Policies	1	1	1	1
13. Centre for Advancing Emissions Reduction	1	–	1	–
14. Regional Initiative for the Assessment of the Impact of Climate Change on Water Resources and Socio-Economic Vulnerability in the Arab Region	1	1	1	1
15. Arab Integrated Water Resources Management Network	1	1	1	1
16. Increasing the resilience of both displaced persons and host communities to climate change-related water challenges in Jordan and Lebanon	1	1	–	–
17. Water scarcity initiative (climate change and groundwater)	1	1	1	1
18. Mashreq Waters Knowledge Series	1	1	–	–
19. Regional Initiative for Promoting Small-Scale Renewable Energy Applications in Rural Areas of the Arab Region	1	1	1	–
Seminar, workshops and training events (number of days)	7	7	7	7
20. Seminars and workshops on topics related to climate change and sustainable natural resource management	7	7	7 [8]	7
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	1
21. On topics related to climate action and sustainable natural resource management	2	2	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	8	7	7	7
22. On topics related to climate action and sustainable natural resource management	8	7	7 [8]	7
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: expert groups on environment; water (security) and groundwater; energy; agriculture, food systems; circular economy approaches; and climate change, sustainable energy and critical minerals.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Regional Initiative for the Assessment of the Impact of Climate Change on Water Resources and Socio-Economic Vulnerability in the Arab Region knowledge hub; groundwater knowledge platform; and e-learning on food systems, climate change and sustainable energy.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: briefs, fact sheets and booklets on topics identified in paragraph 22.19 (a) of the present report; side events at major meetings; global and regional events; and webinars.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Subprogramme 2 Gender justice, population and inclusive development

Objective

- 22.31 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to achieve equitable and inclusive social development and reduced inequality, poverty and unemployment in line with the principle of leaving no one behind.

Strategy

22.32 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:

- (a) Develop knowledge products and policy options and solutions, underpinned by the analysis of trends and challenges, international norms and regional perspectives on a wide range of issues pertaining to socioeconomic equality and social protection; social and gender justice; poverty reduction; labour market needs; migration; and the socioeconomic participation and empowerment of women, young people, older persons and persons with disabilities, especially those in vulnerable situations;
- (b) Support mandated reviews against global commitments and agreements; provide technical and policy advice; and strengthen national capacities to assess existing policy and legislative frameworks to identify and operationalize viable legislation and solutions and to mainstream the reduction in inequalities and equal participation, protection and specific needs of those in vulnerable situations into national development plans and budgets;
- (c) Enhance existing and develop new methodologies, regional public goods and interactive tools for the simulation and analysis of policy options and their impact on inclusive development trajectories;
- (d) Engage member States and development stakeholders in dialogue to advocate for the adoption of policy solutions and to forge consensus on issues outlined in paragraph 22.32 (a) above, while promoting South-South (intraregional and interregional) collaboration and peer learning.

22.33 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) National policy frameworks and strategies adopted by member States to address structural inequalities and promote social justice and the greater social inclusion and socioeconomic empowerment and participation of women, young people, older persons, persons with disabilities and migrants, especially those in vulnerable situations;
- (b) Enhanced coverage of peoples of the region, in particular persons in vulnerable situations, through social protection and poverty eradication programmes, and their improved access to decent and equitable employment opportunities.

Programme performance in 2025

Young people in the Arab region are connected with employment opportunities

22.34 Arab labour markets face growing pressure as increasing numbers of educated young people enter the workforce amid an often-limited expansion of formal employment, leading to many young people entering low-paid or informal employment. To support the creation of an enabling environment that enhances the access of young people to decent employment, the subprogramme partnered with the Governments of Egypt, Jordan and Lebanon, 7 Arab universities and more than 30 private sector entities to launch an initiative targeting policymakers, businesses and young people. The subprogramme brought together all stakeholders to discuss labour market policies and presented policy recommendations. Young people were provided with free training in areas where there was a mismatch between skills available and skills needed in the labour market, in order to meet private sector labour demand, and were provided with private sector employment opportunities. Policymakers received tailored policy advice and recommendations and participated in South-South exchanges, and the private sector benefited from guidance on growth and youth employment strategies.

22.35 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.7).

Table 22.7
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Arab policymakers, young people and the private sector have access to analysis and training and internship and employment opportunities through the fully accessible Josour regional portal	Egypt conducted a national dialogue involving the private sector, young people and policymakers on policies to enhance youth engagement and launched its national youth employment portal	20,000 young Arabs upskilled in areas where there is a national skills mismatch

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: member States adopt multidimensional approach to poverty reduction

Programme performance in 2025 and planned target for 2027

- 22.36 The subprogramme's work contributed to two member States, Egypt and Mauritania, developing policy frameworks for the eradication of poverty, which met the planned target.
- 22.37 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.8).

Table 22.8
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Two member States (Iraq and Somalia) adopted a nationalized multidimensional poverty index as a poverty analysis tool	Two member States (Egypt and Jordan) utilized a nationalized multidimensional poverty index and assist tool to assess drivers of poverty, including inequalities and exclusion	Two member States (Egypt and Mauritania) developed policy frameworks for the eradication of poverty	One additional member State develops a policy framework and/or strategy for the eradication of poverty	One additional member State develops a policy framework and/or strategy for the eradication of poverty

Result 2: member States leverage machine learning to forecast budget needs for social assistance programming

Programme performance in 2025 and planned target for 2027

- 22.38 The subprogramme's work contributed to one member State, Jordan, having access to a prototype of a machine learning-enabled model for the forecasting of budget needs for social assistance programmes, which met the planned target.
- 22.39 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.9).

Table 22.9
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Machine learning-enabled general approach for the forecasting of budget needs for social assistance programmes developed	One member State (Jordan) has access to a prototype of a machine learning-enabled model for the forecasting of budget needs for social assistance programmes	One member State operationalizes social assistance budget forecasting models and dashboards	One additional member State has access to a prototype of a machine learning-enabled model for the forecasting of budget needs for social assistance programmes

Result 3: member States identify and initiate priority action for the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 22.40 Formal employment opportunities remain limited in many parts of the Arab region, with people in vulnerable situations, including persons with disability, facing disproportionate barriers to gaining access to decent work. The subprogramme collaborated with the International Labour Organization to equip member States with regional frameworks and modules on inclusive employment, produced a national situational analysis of disability for 18 member States and supported the development of national strategies for the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.41 The lesson for the subprogramme was that the involvement of the private sector and organizations of persons with disabilities in the identification and implementation of priority action for the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities could enhance the relevance and sustainability of such action. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme, in partnership with the International Labour Organization, will launch the “Arab Inclusive Employment and Entrepreneurship Compact”, a tripartite commitment involving public and private actors and organizations of persons with disabilities and will develop a regional road map for policy action on the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities, building on global and regional success stories and best practices.
- 22.42 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.10).

Table 22.10
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Two member States (Iraq and Jordan) developed national strategies on the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities	Two additional member States develop inclusive and participatory national strategies on the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities	Two additional member States develop inclusive and participatory national strategies on the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
			Five member States endorse the Arab Inclusive Employment and Entrepreneurship Compact	Member States consider adoption of the Arab road map on the economic empowerment of persons with disabilities

Deliverables

22.43 Table 22.11 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.11

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^b	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	12	12	12	6
1. Committee on Women	6	6	6	—
2. Committee on Social Development	6	6	6	6
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	9	9	8	4
3. Committee on Social Development	2	2	2	2
4. Committee on Women	4	4	4	—
5. Subcommittees on social protection, gender and the Sustainable Development Goals, and the intersessional group of experts on disability	3	3	2 [3]	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	5	2	3
6. Enhancing the employment of persons with disability	1	1	—	1
7. Assessing skills and skills-matching techniques	1	1	1	—
8. Towards the Beijing +30 review	1	1	—	—
9. Strengthening social protection systems	1	1	1	1
10. Women and peace and security: moving from plans to action	—	—	—	—
11. Advancing sustainable urban development in the Arab region	—	1	—	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	22	13	10	10
12. Social justice, including integrating social justice principles into public policies and programmes	8	8	— [2]	—
13. Gender justice and women's empowerment	4	1	4	4
14. Population development, ageing, disability and migration	4	2	4 [6]	4
15. Multidimensional poverty and social protection	6	2	2 [4]	2
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	2	1
16. On gender justice and women's empowerment; social protection; poverty; inequality; the future of work; and disability and migration	3	3	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	20	16	16	16
17. On gender justice and women's empowerment; social protection; poverty; inequality; the future of work; and disability and migration	20	16	16 [22]	16

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^b	2027 planned
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C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: meetings of expert groups on the advancement of women in the public sphere; women's economic empowerment; financial inclusion; social protection; poverty; inequality; informality and the labour market; the future of work; urban development; disability; migration; ageing; and young people.

Databases and substantive digital materials: social protection programme – rapid assessment framework; ESCWA Skills Monitor; gender justice portal; gender policy simulator platform; multidimensional poverty index.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: campaign, promotional materials and closing ceremony for the 16 days of Activism against Gender-based Violence;^a materials on equality in the Arab region; and advocacy campaigns on International Day of Older Persons and International Migrants Day.

External and media relations: commentaries on violence against women and on the economic empowerment of women.

^a See General Assembly resolution 77/193.

^b Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Subprogramme 3 Shared economic prosperity

Objective

- 22.44 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to achieve equitable economic growth, amplify regional interconnectedness and integration, and advance the effective implementation of the Sevilla Commitment of the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development in support of the 2030 Agenda.

Strategy

- 22.45 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- Develop and provide knowledge products and evidence for policymaking related to international trade, logistics and transport, the application of strategic foresight in economic development, public policy monitoring and evaluation systems; economic diversification and macroeconomic stability; debt sustainability and fiscal policies, as a means of enhancing investment in sustainable development priorities; and financing for development, including integrated national financing frameworks;
 - Enhance existing and develop new dynamic, data-driven policy simulation tools (anchored in artificial intelligence and machine-learning approaches) pertaining to trade policy, budgeting, taxation, debt optimization, debt swaps, social expenditure, the monitoring and evaluation of development plans, and contextualized economic modelling; and promote the application of modern technologies to (i) facilitate financing of the Sustainable Development Goals and (ii) trade and logistics;
 - Make available to its member States policy advice and technical expertise and strengthen capacities to deploy strategic foresight and modelling and impact simulation tools in support of decision-making and policy development processes aimed at providing immediate, medium- and long-term solutions to national development challenges in the areas identified in paragraph 22.45(a) above;
 - Promote collaboration, coordination and the exchange of good practice, and foster consensus on priorities and joint initiatives aimed at improving connectivity in global value chains

through export-led strategies, promoting innovative debt solutions and enhancing fiscal space and financing for sustainable development initiatives.

22.46 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Evidence-backed development planning; member States adopting policy frameworks, including those anchored in data-driven tools, to address structural economic challenges; improved debt management and sustainability; enhanced equity, efficiency and effectiveness of public spending and budgeting, including on national development priorities; new trade opportunities and economic diversification, including enhanced operational environments for small and medium-sized enterprises; and the creation of fiscal space for the financing of the Sustainable Development Goals and social investment in basic social services and sustainable development goals;
- (b) Increased contribution of small and medium-sized enterprises to national and regional economies, and greater economic participation and empowerment of individuals, including those in vulnerable situations.

Programme performance in 2025

Jordan and Tunisia developed macro-fiscal policies for enhanced social sector financing and fiscal sustainability

- 22.47 Allocating resources for social spending remains a challenge for many countries amid evolving global economic conditions and continued fiscal constraints. The subprogramme, in collaboration with the Department of Economic and Social Affairs, supported member States in strengthening their capacity to develop macro-fiscal policies to enhance social sector financing through macroeconomic modelling. This was done through a dynamic policy simulation tool that is built on the country-specific World Economic Forecasting Model and is customized to the national context. The tool provided a user-friendly interface to make policy simulations accessible to high-level policymakers and enabled targeted capacity-building, equipping officials from finance and planning ministries with the model, interface, user manuals and tailored policy recommendations and simulations needed for financing social sectors while maintaining fiscal sustainability.
- 22.48 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.12).

Table 22.12
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Jordan and Tunisia formulated policy scenarios for social sector financing, assessing their budget implications in coherence with macro-fiscal sustainability

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: enhanced debt sustainability for increased investment in sustainable development priorities

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.49 The subprogramme's work contributed to two member States, Mauritania and Tunisia, developing innovative and sustainable debt financing strategies, which met the planned target.

- 22.50 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.13).

Table 22.13

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States gained access to regional and country-specific analyses on debt optimization and innovative debt solutions	Two member States (Mauritania and Oman) have access and improved capacity to deploy the tool and recommendations to optimize debt and identify innovative and sustainable debt financing strategies	Two member States (Mauritania and Tunisia) developed innovative and sustainable debt financing strategies	One additional member State develops an innovative and sustainable debt financing strategy	One member State issues an innovative financing instrument, which leads to the financing of sustainable development projects

Result 2: member States reach bilateral trade agreements beyond the region
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.51 The subprogramme's work contributed to two member States, Egypt and Saudi Arabia, having access to national global economy-wide trade simulator interface platforms, which met the planned target.
- 22.52 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.14).

Table 22.14

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Arab trade simulator interface is available to member States	Two member States (Egypt and Saudi Arabia) have access to national global economy-wide trade simulator interface platforms	One member State applies the global economy-wide trade simulator interface to develop a bilateral trade agreement	One additional member State uses the global economy-wide trade simulator interface in trade agreement negotiations

Result 3: Arab countries conduct macroeconomic impact assessments for economic diversification
Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 22.53 The Arab region is exposed to external shocks, which can affect economic growth prospects across many Arab countries. The subprogramme has supported policymakers in evaluating scenarios, assessing trade-offs and designing policies for inclusive growth and macroeconomic stability. This was delivered through ex ante policy simulations, generated with an enhanced structural macroeconomic model and presented through an interactive tool.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.54 The lesson for the subprogramme was that its macroeconomic support tools needed to be sufficiently comprehensive and adaptable to help member States to assess the macroeconomic implications of policies related to public expenditure, taxation, economic diversification, sectoral development and exposure to global shocks. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will deliver national dynamic, country-specific impact assessment and scenario-planning tools and build the capacity of member States to evaluate economic scenarios and assess policy options, especially for diversification, thereby supporting the design of alternative strategies.
- 22.55 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.15).

Table 22.15

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Member States have access to a policy simulation tool that is calibrated to perform policy simulations for macroeconomic impact assessment and economic diversification	Member States have access to a dynamic impact assessment and policy simulation tool to support macroeconomic scenario-planning	Two member States conduct macroeconomic impact assessment and policy simulations on economic diversification	One additional member State conducts macroeconomic impact assessment and policy simulations on economic diversification One member State develops a policy on promoting the non-oil sector to further diversify the economy

Deliverables

- 22.56 Table 22.16 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.16

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	12	12	12	12
1. Committee on Trade Policies	—	6	6	—
2. Committee on Transport and Logistics	6	6	— [6]	6
3. Committee on Financing for Development	6	—	6 [—]	6
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	8
4. Committee on Trade Policies	—	4	4	—
5. Committee on Transport and Logistics	4	4	— [4]	4
6. Committee on Financing for Development	4	—	4 [—]	4

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	3	2	2
7. Arab integrated road safety observatory	1	1	1	–
8. Climate/Sustainable Development Goals debt swap initiative	–	–	1	1
9. Capacity development of Arab States on macroeconomic forecasts and policy simulations on financing social expenditure and the Sustainable Development Goals	–	1	–	–
10. Capacity development on computable general equilibrium models	–	–	–	1
11. Developing trade simulator interfaces	–	1	–	–
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	8	5	6	6
12. Seminars and workshops on public finance; debt and innovative financing instruments; financing for development; trade policy and facilitation; transport and logistics; economic modelling; and use of policy simulators	8	5	6 [8]	6
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1	1
13. Macroeconomic outlook in the Arab region	1	1	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	20	13	12	10
14. On macroeconomic outlook; public finance and social expenditure; debt optimization strategies; financing for development and illicit financial flows; trade policy; and transport connectivity and logistics	20	13	12 [17]	10
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: expert groups on public finance; debt and innovative financing instruments; financing for development; trade policy and facilitation; transport connectivity; dynamic computable general equilibrium economic modelling; and illicit financial flows.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Arab trade simulator interface; global economy-wide trade simulator interface; financing for development gateway; integrated budget intelligence toolkit; social expenditure monitor; debt optimization portal; macro-fiscal modelling and forecasting tool; and index simulator for policymakers in the Arab region.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: side event at the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development and other global and regional events; webinars; and factsheets and information material on topics identified in paragraph 22.45 of the present report				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Subprogramme 4 Statistics, the information society and technology

Objective

- 22.57 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen the development of official statistical frameworks, improve the quality and availability of statistics and advance the information society by accelerating the integration of technology and innovation for sustainable development in the Arab region.

Strategy

- 22.58 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Develop and promote methodologies and tools to enhance the capacities of national statistical systems to implement and adapt to evolving international statistical frameworks, including the

2025 System of National Accounts and digital-era statistical classifications, and promote the integration of innovative data sources and geospatial information and frontier technologies;

- (b) In line with global and regional processes, such as the Global Digital Compact, the World Summit on the Information Society+ 20 Forum High-Level Event 2025 and the Arab Digital Agenda for 2023–2033, develop knowledge products, models, toolkits and platforms, and enhance the foresight and analytical capacity of policymakers and practitioners in member States to use data and evidence in shaping and formulating digital development agendas, policy frameworks and strategies, for inclusive digital infrastructure, transformation, economy, government and accessibility, in support of the implementation of the 2030 Agenda;
- (c) Build national capacities to produce and utilize quality statistics and data for evidence-based policymaking and provide technical support for the development and adoption of modern policy frameworks, statistical methodologies and innovative solutions to monitor and report on sustainable development indicators, and increase the value created from data systems, geospatially enabled information and digital public infrastructure;
- (d) Convene intergovernmental and technical, multi-stakeholder forums to foster consensus and facilitate dialogue and exchanges, with the aim of promoting cooperation, partnerships and coordination and incentivizing investment in advancing both the digital development and modernization of official statistics.

22.59 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced value chain of timely, accessible, interoperable and integrated data from diverse sources, including administrative, geospatial and disaggregated data, that is compliant with international statistical standards and governance principles;
- (b) Member States developing, adopting and implementing forward-looking statistical and digital policy frameworks harnessing digital and emerging technologies, as a means of accelerating the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened national accounts in the Arab region for evidence-based policymaking

- 22.60 Robust and reliable national accounts support informed, evidence-based policymaking and sound economic management in all countries, including in countries affected by armed conflict where data gaps may hinder recovery planning and investment decisions. The subprogramme supported Jordan and the Syrian Arab Republic in aligning their national accounts with the 2008 System of National Accounts, to help them to build institutional capacities, enhancing methodological rigour and ensuring international comparability. In the Syrian Arab Republic, the subprogramme coordinated with the planning and statistics authority and national stakeholders to compile gross domestic product data across the 17 core economic activities, in accordance with international statistical standards for national accounts, thereby restoring the country's ability to produce internationally comparable macroeconomic statistics for the first time in recent years, enabling policymakers to ground recovery strategies and policy dialogue in reliable evidence. In Jordan, the subprogramme enhanced national accounts capacity by expanding coverage to priority areas, including the non-formal sector.
- 22.61 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.17).

Table 22.17

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Jordan published revised gross domestic product estimates, incorporating the non-formal sector, in line with the 2008 System of National Accounts The Syrian Arab Republic produced preliminary gross domestic product estimates that are in line with the 2008 System of national Accounts

Planned results for 2027
Result 1: geostatistical evidence enhances decision-making and development planning in the Arab region
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.62 The subprogramme's work contributed to two national statistical offices, in Jordan and Yemen, producing geostatistical data sets, which met the planned target.
- 22.63 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.18).

Table 22.18

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
All member States have access to an initial 12 layers of geostatistical information Two member States (Jordan and Lebanon) initiate pilot projects to enhance their statistical data sets with geospatial information	All member States have access to an additional 12 layers of geostatistical information, in particular those related to climate and the environment	Two national statistical offices (Jordan and Yemen) produced geostatistical datasets	One member State utilizes the geostatistical atlas of the Arab world to generate evidence for decision-making or policy development	Two additional member States utilize the geostatistical atlas of the Arab world to generate evidence for decision-making or policy development

Result 2: Arab member States, including least developed countries, produce external trade statistics

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.64 The subprogramme's work contributed to three member States, Libya, the Sudan and the Syrian Arab Republic, enhancing their capacity to produce external trade statistics, which met the planned target.
- 22.65 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.19).

Table 22.19
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Estimates for trade statistics are available to Iraq, Libya, Somalia, the Sudan, the Syrian Arab Republic and Yemen	Three member States (Libya, Sudan and Syrian Arab Republic), have enhanced capacity in producing trade statistics	At least one least developed Arab member State produces trade statistics	— ^a

^a Please see paragraph 22.11 of the present report.

Result 3: policymakers use the integrated regional data platform for evidence-based policymaking

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 22.66 The adoption of modernized statistical systems and integrated regional data can help to meet today's complex and fast-changing policy needs. By leveraging digital technologies, artificial intelligence and interoperable data platforms, countries can generate timely and comparable statistics to monitor progress made in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and address cross-border challenges such as climate change, migration and regional economic integration. In 2024, the Arab Development Portal was upgraded to harmonize statistical methodologies, integrate alternative data sources and link data with policy analysis through artificial intelligence-enabled data-processing and interoperability layers, enabling the subprogramme to support member States in enhancing statistical systems and integrating alternative data sources and digital solutions in order to support Goal monitoring and inform policymaking.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.67 The lesson for the subprogramme was that addressing individual statistical gaps in isolation might limit the ability of member States to generate integrated evidence for policymaking. In applying the lesson, and building on the 2024 upgrade, the subprogramme will further enhance the Arab Development Portal, transforming it into a regional data-policy integration system by embedding artificial intelligence-driven predictive analytics, geospatial modelling and policy scenario simulation tools to support interactive and forward-looking analysis. It will also strengthen member States' capacity to generate disaggregated indicators and integrate alternative and big data sources into policy design and impact assessments using shared regional data frameworks, thereby promoting coordination and harmonization for comparable, policy-relevant data and statistics.
- 22.68 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.20).

Table 22.20

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Qatar and Saudi Arabia updated consumer price index baskets	Member States endorsed a regional road map for the modernization of civil registration and vital statistics	Jordan, Saudi Arabia and the Syrian Arab Republic implemented Sustainable Development Goals accelerator models to fast-track national progress	member States produce regionally comparable Sustainable Development Goals data and publish it in the Arab Development Portal	An additional seven member States produce regionally comparable Sustainable Development Goals data and publish it in the Arab Development Portal
Member States have enhanced capacity to manage and utilize existing and scattered administrative data for Sustainable Development Goal monitoring		Lebanon initiated the implementation of civil registration and vital statistics reforms	At least three member States improve data quality generation and reporting on progress in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals	An additional five member States use the Arab Development Portal to generate customized national policy briefs and conduct forward-looking policy scenario analyses

Deliverables

22.69 Table 22.21 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.21

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	–	–	5	–
1. Committee on Technology and Development	–	–	2 [4]	–
2. Statistical Committee	–	–	3 [6]	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	12	15	14	6
3. Committee on Technology for Development	–	4	4	–
4. Statistical Committee	–	–	2 [4]	–
5. ESCWA Technology Centre Advisory Board and Technical Committee	2	–	–	–
6. The Bureau of the Statistical Committee	–	–	–	–
7. Standing working groups of the Statistical Committee on economic statistics, demographic and social statistics and disability in the Sustainable Development Goals	4	5	2 [4]	2
8. Task force on Sustainable Development Goals data of the Regional Coordination Platform for Arab States	–	–	2	–
9. Regional Committee of United Nations Global Geospatial Information Management for the Arab States	2	–	2	2

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
10. League of Arab States on Internet governance; automated digital network systems; the digital economy; innovation policies; enhanced information and communications technology (ICT) cooperation; ICT strategy; science, technology and innovation; and ICT for the Sustainable Development Goals	4	6	2 [4]	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	1	1
11. ESCWA Technology Centre	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	24	12	10	12
Seminars and workshops on:				
12. Sustainable Development Goals statistics, including disability and gender statistics; big data and open data; Sustainable Development Goals measuring and reporting; digital inclusion; digital transformation; emerging technologies, digital government, digital economy, e-commerce; and entrepreneurship	24	12	10 [22]	12
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	2	1
13. On statistics and indicators; Sustainable Development Goals data; integrating data systems, including non-traditional data sources; national accounts; purchasing power parity; monitoring of and follow-up on the 2030 Agenda; digital development; and technology and innovation for sustainable development	3	3	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	5	5	6
14. On statistics and indicators; Sustainable Development Goals data; integrating data systems including non-traditional data sources; national accounts; purchasing power parity; monitoring of and follow-up on the 2030 Agenda; digital development; and technology and innovation for sustainable development	6	5	5 [8]	6
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: meetings of experts on digital development; regulations and legislation to promote the information society; Internet governance; frontier technologies; entrepreneurship; technology transfer; and innovation.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Arab Sustainable Development Goals gateway; Arab Digital Agenda for 2023–2033; Arab Digital Inclusion Platform; Arab Inflation Monitor; and Arab Open and Innovative Government Portal.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: annual statistics newsletter; and technology bulletin.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Subprogramme 5 2030 Agenda and SDG coordination

Objective

- 22.70 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to accelerate progress towards sustainable development in the Arab region in line with the 2030 Agenda and to advance intraregional collaboration and a multi-stakeholder approach to key regional and subregional sustainable development issues.

Strategy

- 22.71 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Advocate and partner with a diverse set of stakeholders, including policymakers, the private sector, academic institutions and civil society, for principled action towards the implementation

of the 2030 Agenda, in line with the commitment to “leave no one behind” and a people-centred approach to development, in order to promote a whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach;

- (b) Develop and disseminate knowledge products underpinned by the analysis of member States’ progress towards the implementation of the 2030 Agenda, including gaps in policy frameworks, and promote transformative development solutions for accelerating inclusive, sustainable development in the region;
- (c) Support the five Arab least developed countries, within the framework of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries, by strengthening their institutional capacities for implementing the 2030 Agenda and graduating from the least developed countries category;
- (d) Enhance capacities to conduct integrated monitoring and reporting, at the local, national and regional levels, of the progress against specific Sustainable Development Goals and targets, including through building national and institutional capacity to conduct voluntary national reviews and the identification of policy gaps; identify and disseminate innovative policy solutions and recommendations; ensure that the region’s perspective is reflected through the global lens; and foster cross-sectoral coordination of the Commission’s support to member States’ efforts to achieve the Goals;
- (e) Convene, and ensure ongoing support to and follow-up on various platforms, in connection with the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development, to facilitate multi-stakeholder engagement and dialogue and peer-to-peer exchanges; to foster consensus on sustainable development priorities and action, including for a global development agenda beyond 2030; to promote regional (South-South) and triangular collaboration and coordination; and to support cross-sectoral cooperation and the alignment of national development priorities and plans with both the 2030 Agenda and resources available for their implementation.

22.72 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced commitment of policymakers and practitioners, regional intergovernmental organizations, the private sector, including financial institutions; academia and think tanks, and civil society organizations in the Arab region to the principles of the 2030 Agenda;
- (b) Adoption by member States and development stakeholders of a more participatory, whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach to the implementation of and follow-up on Sustainable Development Goal priorities and related actions;
- (c) Improved utilization by member States and development stakeholders of available dialogue and advocacy platforms as a means of promoting consensus, peer-to-peer learning and coordination at the national, regional and global levels with respect to sustainable development priorities and action, including for a global development agenda beyond 2030; and mobilizing sustained, targeted financing for an accelerated implementation of the 2030 Agenda;
- (d) Improved capacity of policymakers and other stakeholders to identify policy gaps and related policy opportunities and solutions and take action to advance the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

Programme performance in 2025

Member States agree on a shared position to negotiate the political declaration of the Second World Summit for Social Development

22.73 The Second World Summit for Social Development was a platform to renew the commitments made under the Copenhagen Declaration on Social Development and to inject new momentum into the implementation of the 2030 Agenda. The subprogramme, in collaboration with the other regional economic commissions, analysed social development progress and challenges across regions and identified policy lessons to inform the next phase of action. To strengthen the engagement and

negotiation capacity of member States, the subprogramme prepared a policy brief and a set of key messages outlining priority actions required to achieve inclusive social development amid armed conflict, climate change, fiscal constraints and evolving demographic, environmental, technological and labour market trends. Concurrently, it facilitated regional and subregional dialogues with governments – including ministries of labour, social affairs and foreign affairs – and other stakeholders and collaborated with the League of Arab States to facilitate consensus at the ministerial level.

22.74 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.22).

Table 22.22

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	–	Member States adopt, by ministerial consensus, a set of regional priorities to consolidate their shared position for the Second World Summit for Social Development

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: increased private sector investment in regional and national sustainable development priorities

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.75 The subprogramme's work contributed to laying the groundwork for accelerating the financial inclusion of underserved groups and initiating discussions with the Central Bank of Jordan and the Association of Banks of Jordan, which did not meet the planned target of one member State and private sector representatives jointly agreeing on a set of sustainable development priorities for private sector contributions. The target was not met owing to liquidity-related constraints, which impeded the recruitment of a consultant to identify challenges to the financial inclusion of selected underserved groups and the organization of a national multi-stakeholder consultation to bring together policymakers, financial institutions and underserved groups to define priorities.
- 22.76 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.23).

Table 22.23

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
The Union of Arab Banks committed to mobilizing up to \$1 trillion in Sustainable Development Goal-related financing by 2030	Member States and private sector leaders engaged in a regional dialogue on support for and financing of Sustainable Development Goal priorities	Central Bank of Jordan and the Association of Banks of Jordan engaged in a national dialogue on accelerating financial inclusion of underserved groups	One additional member State and private sector representatives jointly agree on a set of sustainable development priorities for private sector contributions	One additional member State and private sector representatives jointly agree on private sector contributions to sustainable development

Result 2: member States identify and address policy gaps linked to the implementation of the 2030 Agenda

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.77 The subprogramme's work contributed to the identification of gaps in capacities and skills to undertake Sustainable Development Goal public policy assessments and of entry points to bridge those gaps, which did not meet the planned target of member States having access to regional modules and frameworks on public policy assessments. The target was not met owing to liquidity-related constraints, which impeded the development of the regional modules and frameworks and the organization of a regional voluntary national review workshop.
- 22.78 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.24).

Table 22.24

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Member States have access to regional Sustainable Development Goal policy trends, opportunities and gaps, and commensurate policy solutions are proposed	Identification of gaps in capacities and skills to undertake Sustainable Development Goal public policy assessments and of entry points to bridge those gaps	One member State identifies a national Sustainable Development Goal policy gap and related policy solution(s)	At least one additional member state identifies a national Sustainable Development Goal policy gap and related policy solution(s)

Result 3: a regional outlook in place for identifying medium- to long-term regional development pathways

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 22.79 The formulation of medium- to long-term regional development priorities and plans provides an important avenue to address persistent developments challenges and close existing gaps in implementation. The subprogramme analysed the region's progress in advancing internationally agreed development frameworks and commitments, reviewed national policy landscapes and drew policy lessons. It also facilitated a dialogue on effective regional and international cooperation affecting global action on shared development problems.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.80 The lesson for the subprogramme was that it needed to facilitate member State agreement on a shared set of guidelines to enable a more invigorated, targeted and implementation-oriented approach to sustainable development in the medium to long term. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will establish an Arab advisory board, composed of government, think tank and civil society representatives, to develop a set of guidelines to help to shape the region's common medium- to long-term priorities, aspirations and needs for sustainable development. It will also provide member States with the knowledge base and multi-stakeholder dialogue platforms needed to identify and articulate the areas in which regional coordination and cooperation would maximize the benefits of international mechanisms for member States and the region.
- 22.81 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.25).

Table 22.25
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	—	An Arab advisory board for common medium- to long-term regional development pathways is established	Member States develop a set of guidelines to shape the region's common medium- to long-term regional development pathways

Deliverables

22.82 Table 22.26 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.26
Subprogramme 5: deliverables for 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	4	4
1. Meetings of the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development	8	8	4 [8]	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	—	—
2. ESCWA Stories	1	1	— [1]	—
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	3	1	—	—
3. Voluntary national review workshops	3	1	— [3]	—
Publications (number of publications)	—	—	—	—
4. Arab Sustainable Development Report	—	—	—	—
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	2	1	1
5. Annual Sustainable Development Goals review	1	1	1	1
6. On sustainable development	2	1	— [2]	—
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: consultation with the task force of the Arab Forum for Sustainable Development; advice to global and regional events on the 2030 Agenda; financial inclusion consultation and advice to the community of practice on voluntary national reviews; meetings of the Arab advisory board and the relevant expert group on common medium- to long-term regional development pathways; and consultation on the 2028 Arab Sustainable Development Report.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: compendium of good voluntary national review practices.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).

Subprogramme 6

Governance and conflict prevention

Objective

- 22.83 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance just, peaceful and inclusive societies, especially for people living under occupation or in conflict or post-conflict settings; to improve governance and strengthen effective, efficient and accountable public institutions; and to enhance service delivery.

Strategy

- 22.84 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Generate and make available evidence-based and foresight-driven policy analysis and recommendations to member States and relevant stakeholders, grounded in the principles of a human development approach, with a focus on mitigating the impact of conflict and occupation on the capacity to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals, facilitating national recovery and reconciliation and improving governance and institutional capacities to deliver basic services, anticipate risks and respond to shocks; strengthening regional cooperation on governance and public administration; and boosting competitiveness, including consumer protection and fair market mechanisms;
 - (b) Provide technical expertise, methodologies and digital tools while enhancing capacities to identify and operationalize immediate, medium- and long-term solutions, aimed at pre-emptively addressing emerging socioeconomic, environmental and governance challenges and conflicts; enhancing prevention, recovery and development planning; improving transparency, accountability and accessibility in service delivery and the efficiency of State-run services; and reinforcing competition policies and consumer protection frameworks to foster trust and inclusive growth;
 - (c) Foster South-South (intraregional and interregional) and triangular cooperation, including through foresight and early warning mechanisms, and build consensus on priorities and action required to minimize the impact of conflict and any sudden shocks, inter alia, on the ability of member States to advance their national development agendas;
 - (d) Support the five Arab least developed countries, within the framework of the Doha Programme of Action (2022–2031), by strengthening their institutional capacities for implementing the 2030 Agenda and graduating from the least developed countries category;
 - (e) Enhance the capabilities of Palestinian institutions to mitigate the adverse effects of the Israeli occupation on development, including supporting national recovery and resilience efforts and capacities in the Occupied Palestinian Territory and reducing the asymmetric dependency of its economy.
- 22.85 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Improved understanding and prevention of development challenges associated with sudden shocks, including conflict, and more effective mitigation of their impact on national development, with the aim of strengthening recovery pathways and enhancing national resilience;
 - (b) More effective, transparent and accountable public institutions, in particular in the five Arab least developed countries, with enhanced capabilities to deliver basic services in a transparent, accessible and inclusive way through modernized and effective public administration systems;
 - (c) Operationalization of a contextualized, people-centred approach to development planning and policy-formulation;

- (d) A more competitive and transparent business environment and more effective consumer protection mechanisms.

Programme performance in 2025

Oman employs evidence-based local development planning

- 22.86 Oman Vision 2040 provides a blueprint to help Oman to remain competitive and further diversify its economy supporting innovation-led, balanced and decentralized development with equitable growth across all governorates. The subprogramme supported the Sultanate of Oman in developing and institutionalizing the governorate competitiveness index as a strategic tool for local development planning. In close collaboration with the Ministry of Economy in Oman, the subprogramme designed the index framework, consolidating it into 4 themes, 13 pillars and 61 indicators. Broad national ownership was secured through a series of consultative meetings with ministries, governorates and private sector representatives, embedding a participatory approach into the process.
- 22.87 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.27).

Table 22.27
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Oman identified the priorities for the framework for the governorate competitiveness index strategic tool for directing investment and determining development priorities	Oman launched the governorate competitiveness index with a digital platform and simulation tool, enabling policymakers to compare performance across governorates and assess policy choices

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: modernization of public administration systems for effective and transparent public governance and socioeconomic development

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 22.88 The subprogramme's work contributed to two member States, Jordan and Mauritania, introducing reforms to modernize their public administration systems, which exceeded the planned target of one member State.
- 22.89 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.28).

Table 22.28

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Member States receive advice on workable solutions to systemic challenges facing their public administration systems for more effective public service delivery	Three member States (Saudi Arabia, United Arab Emirates and Yemen) developed transparency measures to combat corruption in the public sector Member States reached an agreement to convene on anti-corruption measures on an annual basis during the second regional dialogue on corruption (Arab Forum against Corruption)	Two member States, Jordan and Mauritania, introduced reforms to modernize their public administration system	One additional member State introduces reforms to modernize its public administration system	One additional member State introduces reforms to modernize its public administration system

Result 2: member States develop and deploy development policies resilient to fragility and sudden shocks**Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 22.90 The subprogramme's work contributed to two member States, Iraq and Yemen, enhancing their capacity to integrate recovery readiness and resilience into sustainable development initiatives, which met the planned target.
- 22.91 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.29).

Table 22.29

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
—	Nine member States (Iraq, Jordan, Lebanon, Libya, Somalia, the Sudan, the Syrian Arab Republic and Yemen, as well as the State of Palestine) adopted the regional standard operating procedure on operationalizing integrated humanitarian, development and peace approaches in fragile settings	Two member States (Iraq and Yemen) have enhanced capacity to integrate recovery readiness and resilience into sustainable development initiatives	Two member States develop integrate national recovery, resilience and development strategies/plans	One member State integrates resilience as an element in national planning

Result 3: strengthened competition governance for transparent and inclusive markets**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 22.92 While fair and transparent markets can support inclusive growth, competition frameworks in the Arab region continue to evolve, with varying levels of enforcement capacity, institutional mandates and specialized expertise. The subprogramme produced an updated Arab Business Legislative Framework, a regional benchmark of competition laws that offers recommendations on competition legislative reforms, and engaged member States in a regional dialogue facilitating coordination and collaboration at the national, regional and international levels.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 22.93 The lesson for the subprogramme was that adopting competition laws represented only a first step and that its support was more impactful when it also addressed enforcement and implementation capacities in line with national contexts. Enforcement also benefits from its application at both the institutional and sectoral levels to ensure that markets function fairly. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will support member States in developing sector-specific strategies for implementing competition law and in strengthening the enforcement of the law at all levels and across sectors.
- 22.94 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 22.30).

Table 22.30

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	—	At least one member State develops sector-specific recommendations to address anti-competitive practices and strengthen enforcement	One member State adopts a legislative reform on competition

Deliverables

- 22.95 Table 22.31 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 22.31

Subprogramme 6: deliverables for 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^b</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	2	2
1. Note of the Secretary-General on the economic and social repercussions of the Israeli occupation on the living conditions of the Palestinian people in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and the Arab population in the occupied Syrian Golan to the General Assembly and the Economic and Social Council	1	1	1	1
2. Reports to the ESCWA ministerial session on the social and economic impact of the Israeli occupation: thematic focus	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	–	8	8
3. High-level meeting of the League of Arab States/Arab Administrative Development Organization/ESCWA	4	–	4	4
4. Arab Competition Forum	–	–	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	3	–	1
5. Country-specific and regional projects on integrating peace, recovery and development in conflict-affected and post-conflict countries; development under occupation in the State of Palestine; competition; and competitiveness	3	3	– [1]	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	9	10	5	5
6. Consumer protection	1	2	1	1
7. Governance and major sub-indices (governance, human development index, conflict and the environment)	1	2	2	2
8. Comprehensive risk assessment framework or conflict prevention, recovery and stabilization	1	2	– [2]	–
9. Strategic planning in fragile contexts; effectiveness of basic service delivery	6	4	2 [4]	2
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	2	1
10. On governance and conflict prevention, and strengthening of public institutions	1	1	1	1
11. <i>The Arab Business Legislative Framework</i>	1	1	1	–
12. <i>Arab Development Challenges Report</i>	1	1	–	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	8	6	5	5
13. On recovery and stabilization in post-conflict contexts; mitigating the impact of occupation; institution-building to strengthen resilience, performance and service provision; innovation in the public sector; economic governance; impact of competition reforms on trade policy; and human development and human security ^a	8	6	5 [9]	5
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: post-conflict and sustainable peace; vulnerability assessments and risk mitigation; conflict prevention, recovery and stabilization; institution-building to strengthen resilience and innovation in the public sector; public service delivery; economic governance; mitigating the impact of occupation; and advocacy for policy dialogue.				
Database and other substantive digital materials: Arab Legislation Portal; ESCWA violence early warning system portal; and Arab national development planning portal.				
D. Communications deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: observance of the International Day of Solidarity with the Palestinian people; and materials on the impact of conflict and occupation on the socioeconomic development of the Palestinian people.				

^a See General Assembly resolution 66/290.^b Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 22).